FREE CHECKLIST · VA 101 EP 27

Trial Task Checklist

Use this before, during and after any trial task or skills test. Small details are what get you hired.

Before you start

☐ Read the instructions twice and highlight the deliverable
☐ Note the deadline, time zone and file format they asked for
☐ Ask 1 clear question right away if anything is unclear
☐ Check it is fair: short (1 to 3 hours) and no fee asked from you
☐ Block time in your calendar and aim to finish a day early

While doing the task

☐ Follow the format exactly (sheet, doc, naming, columns)
☐ Keep it simple and clean: consistent fonts, no typos
☐ Double-check names, numbers, links and spelling
☐ If you make an assumption, write it down
☐ Save your work in a shared link with view access

When you submit

☐ Send a link, not only an attachment
☐ Write a 3-line summary: what you did, any assumptions, 1 question
☐ Optional: a 1 to 2 minute Loom walkthrough
☐ Submit before the deadline and thank them
☐ Follow up once after 2 to 3 days if no reply

SAMPLE SUBMISSION MESSAGE

Hi Sarah, here is my trial task: [link]

I cleaned 120 leads, removed 8 duplicates and added the missing emails I could verify. I marked unverified ones in yellow.

One question: do you want phone numbers in +61 format? Happy to adjust. Thanks!

RED FLAGS · VA 101 EP 27

Is this trial task fair?

Most clients are legit. These signs help you spot the ones that are not.

Fair trial task	Red flag
✔ Short: 1 to 3 hours, or paid if longer	✖ Days of unpaid work "as a test"
✔ Uses sample or dummy data	✖ Real client work they will use right away
✔ Clear instructions and a deadline	✖ Vague task, then they disappear
✔ Communication on the platform or email	✖ Moves you to Telegram and asks for fees
✔ No payment asked from you	✖ "Training fee", "starter kit" or "registration fee"
✔ Asks for your portfolio and resume	✖ Asks for bank logins, OTPs or your ID upfront

Your rule of thumb

☐ If it is longer than 3 hours, politely ask if it is paid
☐ Never pay to get a job
☐ Never share OTPs, passwords or bank details
☐ Keep a copy of your work and all messages

IF THE TASK IS TOO LONG

Hi! Thanks for sending this. It looks like around 6 to 8 hours of work. Would it be okay to do a smaller part as a sample, or can we do it as a short paid trial? Happy either way.